

Chapter 26-4

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Early the next morning, Liang Shi was woken up by her alarm clock.

She had slept quite comfortably. When she woke up, she immediately turned off the alarm, afraid of waking Xu Qingzhu. But after turning off the alarm, she turned around and found that Xu Qingzhu was already gone.

She reached to the side and felt that the bed sheets were cold.

Had Xu Qingzhu not come back to sleep in the room last night?

While thinking about this, Liang Shi tied up her hair and went to the bathroom to wash up.

Today was her first day reporting to Dongheng Group, so naturally she couldn't go with a bare face. But she didn't put on heavy makeup either—she simply applied foundation, lipstick and daily eyeshadow, and brushed on a layer of mascara to make her eyelashes curled and long.

While brushing her eyelashes, she thought of Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu's eyelashes seemed to be long and curled enough without mascara.

Thinking this way, her hand became slightly unsteady, and the mascara brush got on the area under her eyes, creating a black smudge.

She immediately looked for tissue to wipe it off, but this mascara was waterproof and quick-drying.

Wiping it only made the area under her eyes even blacker, like she had dark circles.

Liang Shi: "..."

Even makeup veterans would have accidents sometimes.

How ridiculous.

She looked for makeup remover on the cosmetics shelf but didn't find any.

She went back to the room and looked on Xu Qingzhu's vanity table, but didn't see any at first glance.

With no choice, she could only pick up the bottles one by one to read the labels, but many of the cosmetics had no Chinese characters—either strings of Korean text or bottles full of Japanese. The most recognizable one was actually a bottle with all English text, but when Liang Shi looked at it, she found it was a bottle of lotion.

"..."

Liang Shi was helpless. She was trying her best to translate the last bottle on the table that looked somewhat like makeup remover when the bedroom door was pushed open.

Xu Qingzhu walked in.

Liang Shi: "..."

Wasn't it a bit inappropriate to touch someone else's things without asking?

Under Xu Qingzhu's gaze, Liang Shi finally developed a bit of not-quite-conscious awareness.

Holding the bottle in her hand, she said with some difficulty: "I'm looking for makeup remover."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her, finding it hard to ignore the large black smudge under her eyes.

She asked calmly: "Did your eyeshadow smear?"

"No." Liang Shi said: "I accidentally smudged the mascara when I was brushing it on."

Xu Qingzhu walked in, "I see."

She walked to the desk and took out a round box from the drawer that Liang Shi had never seen before.

When the box opened, it contained neatly laid makeup remover pads that gave off a slight alcohol scent.

Xu Qingzhu handed it to her, "What's on the table are all daily skincare products."

"I see." Liang Shi thanked her, "Thank you."

Liang Shi took the box of makeup remover pads into the bathroom. She carefully wiped while looking in the mirror, but the mirror reflected Xu Qingzhu's face.

Xu Qingzhu was standing at the doorway, staring straight at her.

Liang Shi: "..."

She couldn't help asking: "Did I kick you last night?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu said: "You sleep very well."

"Then..." Liang Shi couldn't help it, "Are you looking for me for something?"

Xu Qingzhu paused slightly, "Not exactly."

What did "not exactly" mean? Either there was something or there wasn't—what was "not exactly"?

Moreover, she was already having trouble with her makeup, and now being stared at like this was quite unnerving.

Liang Shi let out a soft breath, "Then you..."

"Alright, there is something." Xu Qingzhu interrupted her, "I'm going to work today."

Liang Shi felt relieved, "I see, then go ahead. Are you going to your own family's company?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "I get off work at six in the evening, but I might work overtime. If I come back very late, you don't need to wait for me for dinner."

"Okay, got it." Liang Shi went along with her words: "I'm also going to work. I didn't like the HR department that my second brother arranged for me before, so this time I'm going to try a newly established department. It should also be six o'clock off work, but I guess the new department will work overtime, so my work hours aren't fixed either. If I'm not back by dinner time, you don't need to wait for me either."

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "Okay."

This negotiation was quite pleasant, and after the negotiation ended, Liang Shi continued struggling with the mirror.

She didn't really want to remove all the makeup on her face for this small smudge, so she could only use a corner of the makeup remover pad to wipe it away, then touch up with foundation afterward—it wouldn't be too troublesome.

But Xu Qingzhu kept standing at the doorway, not leaving even after they had exchanged all the information.

Liang Shi: "..."

Even when she used to be stared at by more than ten cameras and needed close-up shots, she hadn't been this nervous.

Liang Shi couldn't help it, "Is there anything else?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "No."

She answered frankly, but just wouldn't leave.

Liang Shi lowered her hand and asked again: "Do you need to use the bathroom?"

Xu Qingzhu still shook her head, "If I need to, I can go downstairs."

Liang Shi: "..."

Then what are you doing here?

She held back again and again, barely managing not to say this out loud.

To avoid making Xu Qingzhu unhappy and having the system increase her bad luck value.

The main thing was that with Xu Qingzhu standing there, she would get nervous.

And when she got nervous, her hands would shake.

This smudge was caused by unconsciously thinking about Xu Qingzhu's eyelashes and accidentally smearing it.

And now she had to watch.

Liang Shi felt helpless and thought she might as well give up—at worst she'd remove all the makeup and wash her face.

After she turned on the faucet, Xu Qingzhu suddenly spoke up, "Are you not good at applying makeup?"

Liang Shi: "...?"

"How could that be?" Liang Shi immediately denied it, "My makeup skills are pretty good."

Actually, she had even been a beauty blogger for a while.

Because makeup took so long when filming, she would always observe the cosmetics on the table.

Later, when she was bored, she would livestream and chat with fans about what cosmetics were good to use recently, and when she was even more bored, she would even do makeup cosplay.

Though it was all cosplaying anime characters.

She had just had an accident, and this accident happened to be seen by Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu walked in. She turned off the faucet, didn't say whether she believed it or not, but took out a new makeup remover pad from the box.

She folded it twice on her finger.

Then she looked up at Liang Shi and said, "Lower your head."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Ah?" Liang Shi was surprised, but still did as told. She bent down slightly, but still kept some distance from Xu Qingzhu. Xu Qingzhu stood on her tiptoes slightly, raised her hand, and placed the folded makeup remover pad over Liang Shi's lower eyelid.

Not too much, not too little.

It covered everything perfectly without blocking Liang Shi's vision.